

Spacing indicates
differing columns of
text within tablet
(columns i, ii, and iii)

Column i largely missing
from tablet



Tablet with Ludlul bēl Nēmeqi

Clay Cuneiform Tablet,
Iraq,
Late Babylonian c. 1307–1282 BC
British Museum,
BM 32208 reverse

This tablet contains the poem *Ludlul bēl nēmeqi*, also known as the *Poem of the Righteous Sufferer*. The tablet is known to contain the poem in its entirety. The reverse shown here contains fragments from Book IV of the poem. The tablet is thought to have had a colophon, which has been lost.

The story follows Shubshi-meshre-Shakkan, a man who undergoes a great deal of suffering despite his unwavering piety. The tablet shown here contains lines 23 -50 and 101 -119 in the Lenzi translation. This section follows the alleviation of Shubshi-meshre-Shakkan from his condition and his thankfulness to the Gods.

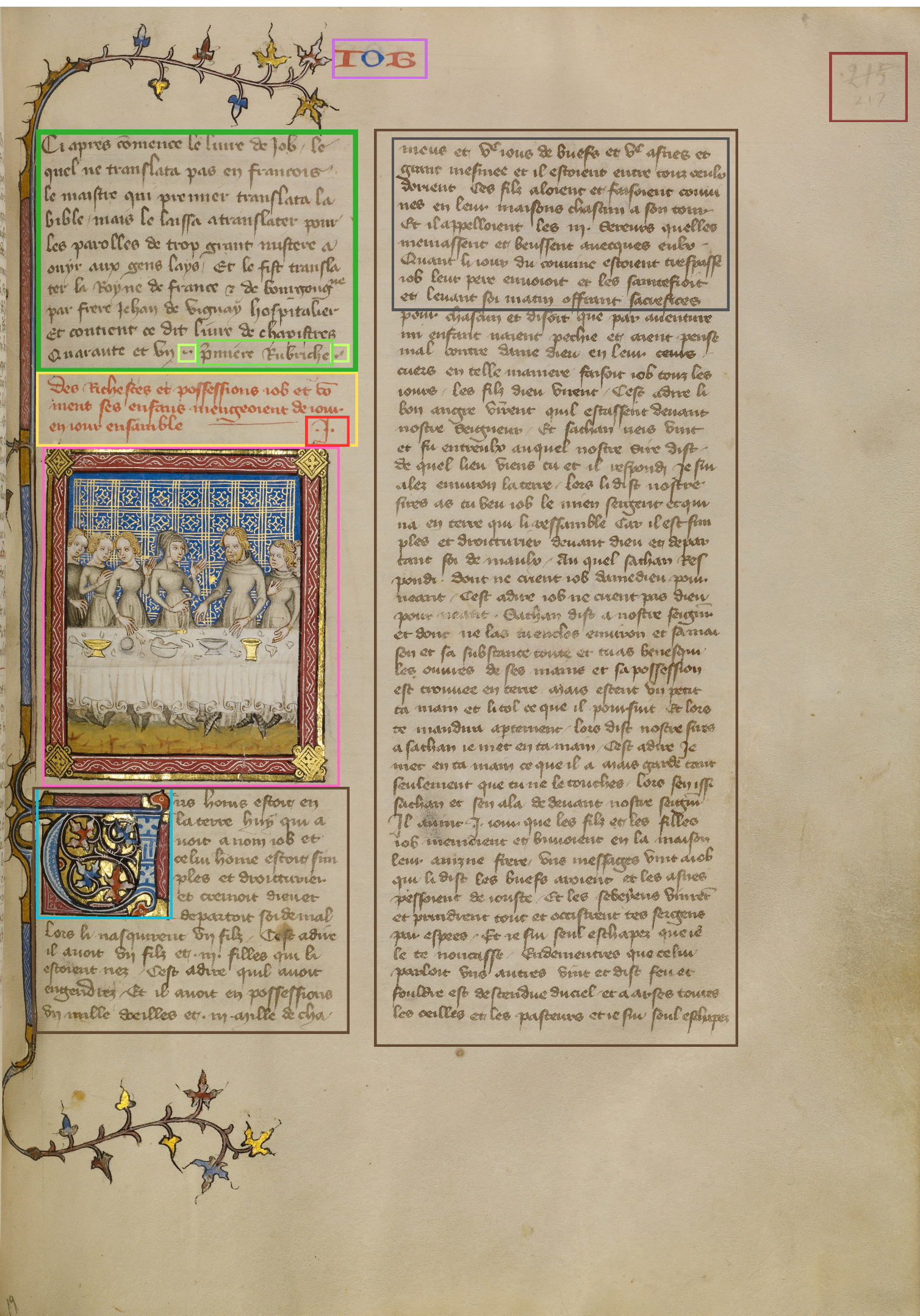
Bibliography:

Lenzi, A., & Annus, A. (2011). A Six-Column Babylonian Tablet of Ludlul Bēl Nēmeqi and the Reconstruction of Tablet IV. *Journal of Near Eastern Studies*, 70(2), 181–205. DOI: 10.1086/661043

Lenzi, A. (2019). Translation of Ludlul Bel Nemeqi. In (Eds.), *Suffering in Babylon*. <https://scholarlycommons.pacific.edu/cop-facbooks/190>

Hätinen, A. (2022). Righteous Sufferer (Ludlul bēl nēmeqi) Chapter IV. With contributions by A. C. Heinrich, E. Jiménez and T. D. N. Mitto. Translated by Benjamin R. Foster. *electronic Babylonian Library*.

<https://doi.org/10.5282/eb/II/2/2>



Pagination related to canon table

Commentary describing that it is the Book of Job that follows along with commentary on its translation into French.

Punctuation around possible signature.

Description of the image that follows. Loosely translated as “The riches and possessions of Job and ... his children eat of... all together”

The letter J with an ellipsis running through it - a possible signes-de-revoi.

Illuminated image of Job, His wife, three daughters, and two of his seven sons at the feast table.

Illuminated letter T that marks the begining of the first chapter of the Book of Job. Out of the T comes a flourish that brackets all the text on the page.

The main text of the Book of Job.

Numbers in pencil that would have been added within the last couple of centuries.

Job and His Family from Bible Historiale, vol. 1

Illuminated Manuscript
Gold and ink on parchment
1360 -1370
Master of Jean de Mandeville (*illuminator*), Guyart des Moullins, and Peter Comestor
J. Paul Getty Museum
Ms. 1, v1, fol. 217, 84.MA.40.1.217

The verso of this leaf contains the begining of the Book of Job.The leaf comes from the Bible Historial - the most common French translation of the Bible of its time. It borrows texts from Guyart des Moullins and Peter Comestor. The commentary on the top of the page describes that what follows is an updated version of the abridged version of Job. This edition was illuminated by Master of Jean de Mandeville in the 14th century. This particular leaf has a depiction of Job and his family before the series of tragedies he will encounter begin.

Bibliography:
Bible historiale. The Morgan Library & Museum. (2018, April 23). <https://www.themorgan.org/manuscript/112314>
Job and his family (the J. paul getty museum collection). Getty. <https://www.getty.edu/art/collection/object/105TVX#full-artwork-details>